

Hollow

Tomorrow Sprint And Game Concept Workbook

For Martin and Rafal - content, ArtPass, gameplay depth, and game identity

Purpose

This workbook turns tomorrow into a focused collaborative sprint: Rafal pushes visible content and art direction, Martin integrates assets and expands gameplay/content systems, and both of you use the design prompts to shape the game identity.

Who	Martin + Rafal
When	Tomorrow production/design session
Baseline	M25 locked vertical slice: 8-room branch, boss key, secret room, boss, hub, shop cards, next portals
Day goal	Make the slice feel more like a game, even with rough content
Primary output	More visible content, clearer next milestones, and answered design questions

Core rule: art can replace visuals, but gameplay stays driven by runtime models, colliders, controllers, and HollowRuntime V2 data.

1. Tomorrow Sprint Shape

Treat tomorrow as a mixed art/code/design sprint. The end-of-day win is not perfection. The win is a more interesting slice, a shared vocabulary, and a backlog that points at the right next milestones.

Timebox	Activity	Output
30-45 min	Morning alignment. Play or review the M25 route and agree on minimum win.	Target list: 2-3 content pieces, 1-2 room/challenge ideas, PDF decisions.
2-3 hours	Parallel production. Rafal makes visible content; Martin integrates/cleans gameplay and content hooks.	First asset replacements, room/challenge candidates, integration notes.
45 min	Midday check. Inspect what landed and choose the afternoon priority.	Cut scope if needed; protect the end-of-day playable route.
2-3 hours	Second production block. Finish the highest-impact visible/content/gameplay tasks.	Playable smoke path or ready-to-integrate content pack.
45-60 min	Shared review. Play the slice and answer workbook prompts.	Must-fix list, content wish list, design decisions, next milestone candidates.

Minimum Win Agreement

- What would make tomorrow feel successful even if no final art exists?
- Which one player-facing improvement matters most: readability, challenge, atmosphere, or variety?
- What must not break while we experiment?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ 2-3 visible content swaps
- ☐ 1 new approved room
- ☐ 1 challenge idea playable
- ☐ 1 concept direction chosen

2. Rafal Track - Art, Materials, VFX, Basic Animation

Rafal's work should prioritize visible replacements mapped to existing ArtPass roles. The goal is strong silhouette and readability first; beauty can arrive later, the little gremlin of polish will get its day.

Priority	Asset target	Role / integration note
1	Room floor + rock obstacle	RoomFloor, RoomObstacleRock. Must be visual-only; runtime colliders remain authoritative.
1	Doors: locked, active, cleared, unavailable	DoorLocked, DoorActive, DoorCleared, DoorUnavailable. Color/state readability is critical.
1	Player placeholder	Player. Simple readable silhouette, idle bob/breathing if easy.
2	Enemy set: normal, flying, charger, turret, splitter	EnemyNormal, EnemyFlying, EnemyCharger, EnemyTurret, EnemySplitter. Different silhouettes more important than detail.
2	Stone Warden boss silhouette	EnemyBoss. Larger readable boss, slow/weighty vibe.
2	Reward, boss key, shop stand/card, next portal	RewardPickup, BossKeyPickup, HubShop, NextBranchPortal. Make goals and interactables obvious.
3	VFX placeholders	ProjectileFire, EnemyHit, EnemyDeath, RewardClaim, DoorUnlock, RoomClear, PortalComplete.

- Best handoff: Unity prefab wrappers with materials assigned.
- Acceptable handoff: raw Blender/FBX/textures in a named intake folder.
- Runtime-approved prefabs should live under *Assets/_Hollow/Prefabs/ArtPass/* after integration.
- No gameplay colliders, movement scripts, damage scripts, traversal scripts, or save-state scripts on art prefabs.

Notes / decisions:

3. Martin Track - Programming, Integration, Content, Logic

Martin's work should protect the runtime architecture while making the slice more interesting. Integrate assets through the presentation catalog, add basic content variety, and prepare the next feature milestones.

Priority	Task	Definition of done
1	Integrate Rafal assets through ArtPass roles	At least one high-impact visual replacement appears in the slice without changing gameplay colliders or logic.
1	Playability cleanup	Camera follow, HUD readability, rock/floor contact, door states, and shop-card interactions remain understandable.
2	Create or approve 1-2 content rooms	Rooms validate through HollowRuntime V2 and are ready for DesignerApproved intake.
2	Challenge backlog	M26-M30 candidates become implementation-ready enough to plan next.
3	Quick smoke validation	Manual route or M25 gate confirms New Run, clear room, reward, boss key, hub, shop card.

Programming Focus Choice

- If time is short, which code/content improvement should win?
- What should be deferred even if it is tempting?
- Which regression would be most painful tomorrow?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ Art integration
- ☐ Room content
- ☐ Game feel/physics
- ☐ Challenge menu/content

4. Shared Review Board

Use this page during the afternoon review. Capture observations without arguing with them too early; the pattern will reveal itself after the first pass.

Category	What belongs here	Examples
Must fix	Blocks playability, comprehension, validation, or handoff.	Cannot see branch map; shop card unclear; room collision wrong; camera not following.
Content wish	Would make the game more interesting but does not block the slice.	More room layouts; stronger boss silhouette; secret room reward; hazard tiles.
Design question	Needs an answer before deeper content work.	Why are we collecting souls? What is the hub? What does a boss guard?
Nice weird idea	Potential identity hook worth saving.	Rooms are memories; shopkeeper is a trapped architect; keys are fragments of self.

Notes / decisions:

5. Core Fantasy

This section decides the emotional center. The mechanics can be roguelike, room-based, and combat-heavy, but the player needs a feeling to hold onto.

What should the player feel?

- What is the emotion after clearing a hard room?
- Should the game feel desperate, clever, eerie, playful, tragic, or triumphant?
- What should the player think when they see the next portal?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ Escaping
- ☐ Descending
- ☐ Cleansing
- ☐ Remembering
- ☐ Harvesting
- ☐ Surviving

Why is the world room-based?

- Are rooms physical places, memories, tests, rituals, dreams, or fragments of a machine?
- Why do doors lock until combat clears?
- Why do rooms have macro shapes and repeated anchors?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ Soul prison
- ☐ Dream dungeon
- ☐ Ritual machine
- ☐ Cursed toy diorama
- ☐ Haunted memory-space

Notes / decisions:

6. Why Are We Here?

The current game already has souls, keys, bosses, secrets, shops, branches, and portals. This page asks what those things mean so future systems can reinforce the same world.

Player identity

- Who is the player before the run starts?
- Are they alive, dead, lost, summoned, punished, or searching?
- What do they risk by continuing deeper?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ Lost child/soul
- ☐ Awakened construct
- ☐ Grave robber
- ☐ Memory fragment
- ☐ Failed guardian

Meaning of souls

- Are souls currency, fuel, memory, guilt, time, or pieces of other people?
- Is spending souls morally neutral or uncomfortable?
- What does banking souls mean after a run?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ Currency
- ☐ Memory
- ☐ Fuel
- ☐ Debt
- ☐ Identity fragments

Keys, bosses, and shops

- Why does a boss key exist?
- What does a boss protect?
- Who runs the shop and why do they accept souls?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ Gatekeeper logic
- ☐ Ritual permission
- ☐ Memory lock
- ☐ Debt collector economy

7. World And Story Seeds

Pick ideas that can show up through rooms, rewards, enemy names, shop lines, and challenge names. The story does not need cutscenes yet; it needs a direction that content can echo.

Setting candidates

- Which setting makes the mechanics feel inevitable rather than arbitrary?
- Which setting can Rafal visualize quickly with materials and props?
- Which setting supports both toy-diorama scale and dark dungeon mood?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ Cursed toy diorama
- ☐ Soul prison
- ☐ Dream dungeon
- ☐ Ritual machine
- ☐ Haunted memory archive

The hub

- Is the inter-branch hub safe, fake-safe, or predatory?
- Is it a camp, shop, altar, elevator, ferry, memory room, or machine core?
- Does it change as the player progresses?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ Rest stop
- ☐ Shopkeeper domain
- ☐ Between-world station
- ☐ Soul refinery
- ☐ Memory checkpoint

Notes / decisions:

8. Gameplay Loop And Room Interest

The game needs rooms to be interesting even before final art. Variety can come from layout, pressure, enemy combinations, hazards, rewards, secrets, and rules.

Layer	Question	Content ideas
Layout	What makes a room interesting before enemies spawn?	Rings, lanes, blocked center, diagonal rocks, safe pockets, dangerous corridors.
Enemy mix	What forces different movement decisions?	Turret plus charger, flying plus rock maze, splitter swarm, heavy plus projectile pressure.
Hazards	What can challenge without more AI?	Spikes, holes, timed danger zones, projectile traps, slowing tiles.
Secrets	What makes optional discovery satisfying?	Bonus reward, lore fragment, risk room, shortcut, cursed bargain.
Rewards	What makes pickup exciting?	Immediate stat change, visible VFX, name/effect message, build synergy.

10-minute run target

- How many rooms should feel right in a short run?
- How often should the player see a reward?
- When should the run present a meaningful choice?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ Fast arcade
- ☐ Tense tactical
- ☐ Exploratory roguelite
- ☐ Boss-rush flavored

9. Challenge Design

Challenges can make the prototype feel richer without needing a huge campaign. They also give us fast test cases for systems, enemies, rooms, and balance.

Challenge type	Rule	Why it helps
Fixed seed	Same branch and rewards for everyone.	Good for balance and comparison.
Enemy mix	Rooms bias toward one behavior family.	Tests encounter readability.
Boss challenge	Start near boss or run a short boss-key branch.	Tests boss feel and reward loop.
Secret hunt	Clear branch after finding/entering secret.	Tests optional content and minimap clarity.
Shop-limited	Few rewards, stronger shop dependency.	Tests economy and card UI.
Hazard room	Layouts include spikes/holes/traps.	Prepares physics/logics milestone.

First curated challenge

- What challenge would be fun with the content we already have?
- What challenge would reveal the most bugs?
- What challenge would be easiest to explain in one sentence?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ Boss key rush
- ☐ Turret maze
- ☐ Secret hunter
- ☐ No-shop run
- ☐ Splitter swarm

Notes / decisions:

10. Enemy And Boss Identity

Enemies should be readable by silhouette and behavior. The story layer can come later, but their emotional identity should start now.

Enemy	Gameplay read	Visual/story direction prompt
Normal	Basic pressure and contact danger.	What is the default corrupted thing in this world?
Flying	Bypasses obstacles and changes safe zones.	Should it feel like a soul, insect, toy, or memory shard?
Charger	Windup and burst threat.	What visual tells the player to dodge now?
Turret	Positioning/projectile pressure.	Is it a statue, eye, plant, machine, or trapped guardian?
Splitter	Death creates more pressure.	What makes splitting understandable and not confusing?
Stone Warden	Boss gatekeeper.	What does it guard, and why is it stone?

Boss promise

- What should the first boss teach?
- What should the player remember about Stone Warden after the fight?
- Does defeating it feel like escape, theft, purification, or permission?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ Gatekeeper
- ☐ Prison guard
- ☐ Forgotten statue
- ☐ Debt collector
- ☐ Memory guardian

11. Art Direction Rules

This page gives Rafal a shared target while keeping the work simple. The first art pass should improve readability and mood, not chase final production quality.

Rule	Decision to make	Practical output
Scale	Are rooms tabletop dioramas, full spaces, or both depending on platform?	Keep meter-aligned pivots and simple bounds.
Palette	What colors are sacred, dangerous, rewarding, secret, or locked?	Color language for doors, rewards, enemies, key, portal.
Materials	Is the world stone, wood, cloth, bone, wax, metal, toy plastic, or memory-glass?	2-4 material families for the first pass.
Silhouette	What shapes belong to player, enemies, bosses, interactables?	Readable from top/3-4 camera angles.
Mystery	What should remain strange rather than explained?	Secrets, portal, shopkeeper, soul economy.

Immediate readability priorities

- What must be readable instantly in combat?
- Which interactables need the strongest visual language?
- What can stay rough for now?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ Player
- ☐ Enemy types
- ☐ Projectiles
- ☐ Doors
- ☐ Rewards
- ☐ Boss key
- ☐ Shop cards
- ☐ Portal

Notes / decisions:

12. Progression And Meta Direction

Progression should answer what survives after a run and what the player believes they are building toward. Current systems already separate run-local souls from future banking/meta decisions.

What persists?

- What should the player keep after a successful branch or extraction?
- What should be lost on death?
- Should story knowledge persist even when power does not?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ Banked souls
- ☐ Unlocked rooms
- ☐ Challenge access
- ☐ Lore fragments
- ☐ Shop upgrades
- ☐ Visual changes in hub

What is progress emotionally?

- Does progress mean escaping, understanding, becoming stronger, or restoring something?
- Does the world get easier, stranger, or more dangerous?
- What is the player's long-term hope?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ Freedom
- ☐ Memory recovery
- ☐ Power
- ☐ Debt repayment
- ☐ World restoration
- ☐ Deeper truth

Notes / decisions:

13. Next Milestone Candidates

These are not final commitments. They are a practical menu for the next planning session after tomorrow's review.

Milestone	Purpose	Likely first deliverable
M26: Game Feel And Physics Pass	Tighten movement, collisions, camera, projectile readability, contact damage, obstacle blocking, and room-scale comfort.	Player feel checklist plus Windows/Vision Pro smoke checks.
M27: Challenge Content V1	Add curated challenge entries from the main menu.	Fixed seed, enemy-mix, boss, secret, and shop-limited challenge prototypes.
M28: Room Content Expansion	Build a small approved room pool.	3 single rooms, 2 macro rooms, 1 secret-style room, 1 boss-room candidate.
M29: Enemy/Encounter Pacing Pass	Improve encounter difficulty bands, spawn clarity, and boss readability.	Encounter table tuning and deterministic pacing tests.
M30: Story And Meta Progression Seed	Turn workbook answers into first lore hooks and progression framing.	Run-start, branch-completion, and hub/shop narrative text seeds.

Pick tomorrow's follow-up milestone

- Which milestone unlocks the most value after tomorrow?
- Which one has the fewest unknowns?
- Which one would make the next playtest most exciting?

Useful directions to consider:

- ☐ M26 feel/physics
- ☐ M27 challenges
- ☐ M28 rooms
- ☐ M29 encounters
- ☐ M30 story/meta

14. Open Decisions To Answer Tomorrow

#	Decision	Answer / owner
1	What is the core fantasy: escape, descent, cleansing, remembering, harvesting, or survival?	
2	Who or what is the player?	
3	What exactly are souls?	
4	Why do rooms exist as discrete tests?	
5	What does the inter-branch hub represent?	
6	Who or what runs the shop?	
7	What does Stone Warden guard?	
8	What visual language separates enemy types?	
9	What should secrets reward first: power, lore, risk, shortcuts, or weirdness?	
10	Which next milestone should start after tomorrow?	

End-of-day rule: decisions can be provisional. A useful maybe is better than a perfect blank page.